VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE TESLA DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on Tesla's cars, autonomy, robots, energy and stock

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 16, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF THU OCT 15 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

The Roadster flies, and it is two years away

Tesla's new Roadster drove up a towering curved ramp, hung upside down on fan suction, flipped in the air on SpaceX cold-gas thrusters and later hopped over a Cybercab, Cybertruck, Semi, Model Y and Model 3 at a SpaceX test site in McGregor, Texas, on Thursday night, Reuters reported. A timed run reached 60 mph in a claimed 0.81 seconds. Musk said production starts in 2028. "Turns out the future does have flying cars," he posted.

No price was given. Tesla is taking $50,000 deposits for the Performance version and $250,000 for Thrust; Rocket is invite-only. TSLA slipped 1.29% to $362.44 before the show and was up 5% in premarket trading Friday, according to Reuters. Third-quarter results come Wednesday.

NEXT WEEK · Q3 EARNINGS

Third-quarter results on Wednesday

Wed Oct 21 · results after the close · webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT

Tesla set the date in an 8-K on October 2, when it reported 486,532 deliveries and 13.7 GWh of storage deployed. Analysts expect earnings of $0.45 a share on $28.11 billion in revenue, according to Yahoo Finance. "The margin and cash flow numbers will carry far more weight with investors than anything they saw at the reveal," eToro analyst Josh Gilbert told Reuters.

I · THE ROADSTER

Suction, thrusters and three trims

Tesla showed the car nearly nine years after the first reveal and named 2028 for production.

What it did

A fan system under the car provides up to 2 g of suction, Tesla says, enough to hold it on an inverted, Hot Wheels-like ramp; at the top, SpaceX-supplied thrusters rated at more than 80 kilonewtons flew it forward through a barrel roll and eased it down, Car and Driver reported. The first acceleration run was timed at about one second; after Musk was reminded he had promised less, a second run came in at a claimed 0.81 seconds. Tesla said that is "0.67 seconds (w/ rollout subtracted)." To a post noting 0.81 seconds is "over 3.3 Gs," Musk replied, "You're right, we can do better."



The 2017 Roadster prototype on display at Tesla's headquarters in April 2019. Thursday's car has a new body Tesla says was inspired by the SR-71 and F-35.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON, "TESLA ROADSTER 2.0," WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0

How it works

Engineering vice president Lars Moravy said the car uses 10 thrusters fed by 600 liters of rechargeable compressed air, TechCrunch reported; The Verge put the load at about 250 kilograms of air. "Every usable void in the car is packed with

Carbon Fiber Overwrapped Pressure Vessels (COPVs)," Tesla posted, adding that the thrusters generate "4–5x the force the tires can."

Trims and numbers

- **Performance** ("road ready," two seats): active aerodynamics and suction; 0–60 mph under 1.6 seconds and more than 300 miles of range, per The Verge. $50,000 deposit.
- **Thrust** ("race ready," two seats, limited release): rear cold-gas thrusters for 0–60 mph in under 1 second, per Tesla. $250,000 deposit.
- **Rocket** ("air ready," one seat, invite only): thrusters around the car; "So yes, it can fly." Tesla says it is "not approved for public road use."

Moravy put top speed above 230 mph; Musk said "I think you've got to crack halfway to the speed of sound," Reuters reported. The range is less than half of the 620 miles promised in 2017. Deepwater's Gene Munster called it "an engineering flex with no commercial value beyond embarrassing traditional car makers."

II · FULL SELF-DRIVING (FSD) & ROBOTAXI

Remote operators behind five robotaxi crashes

Two new federal crash reports involve a human driving remotely.

Tesla's latest Standing General Order filings with the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) add two August crashes, in Dallas and Austin, in which a remote support operator was driving a Model Y when it touched an SUV at about 0.4 mph and a dumpster at about 1 mph, Electrek reported. No passengers were aboard. That makes five remote takeovers in Tesla's crash data, all ending in contact, out of 36 robotaxi incident reports. Tesla does not disclose how often remote operators intervene.

QUICK HIT

"The FSD version of this will be something." Google's Sundar Pichai congratulated Musk after the reveal; Musk replied, "It's such an honor working with incredible engineers." Separately, he wrote that "Cybercab will be a gamechanger."

III · SEC FILINGS

Nothing new on EDGAR

No filings for Tesla, Inc. (CIK 0001318605) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Thursday and 8:15 a.m. EDT Friday. Most recent filings on record:

Takeaways

1. The new Roadster drove inverted, flew and hit 60 mph in a claimed 0.81 seconds.
2. Production starts in 2028; deposits are $50,000 (Performance) and $250,000 (Thrust).
3. Two more robotaxi crashes involved remote operators.
4. TSLA fell 1.29% to $362.44 before the show; it rose 5% premarket Friday.
5. Q3 results come Wednesday, October 21, with a 5:30 p.m. EDT webcast.

8-K · Oct 2, 9:04 a.m. EDT — Item 2.02 press release on third-quarter results: 464,391 vehicles produced, 486,532 delivered and 13.7 GWh of storage deployed. Third-quarter financial results come after the close on Wednesday, October 21, with a webcast at 5:30 p.m. EDT. Filing

8-K · Sep 29, 4:38 p.m. EDT — New unsecured credit agreements: a $20.0 billion three-year delayed-draw term loan (Citibank as agent), an $8.0 billion five-year revolving facility and a $2.0 billion 364-day revolving facility (Wells Fargo as agent). Filing

Insider trades, last 120 days (Form 4) — Sep 8: Chief Financial Officer Vaibhav Taneja sold 2,605.75 shares at $360.13 after 6,539 restricted stock units vested on Sep 5 (filed Sep 9). Jun 16: Elon Musk exercised options on 303,960,630 shares at $23.34, with 17,531,857 shares withheld at $404.66 (filed Jun 17).

SOURCES

Posts by @Tesla and @elonmusk on X; Reuters, Car and Driver, TechCrunch, The Verge, Tesla, Electrek; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE.

The Tesla Dispatch is an independent weekday digest of public news, X posts, regulatory filings and market data about Tesla, Inc., and is not affiliated with the company. Quotes are verbatim; emoji in quoted posts are omitted for print. Market data are delayed and may be revised. Not investment advice.

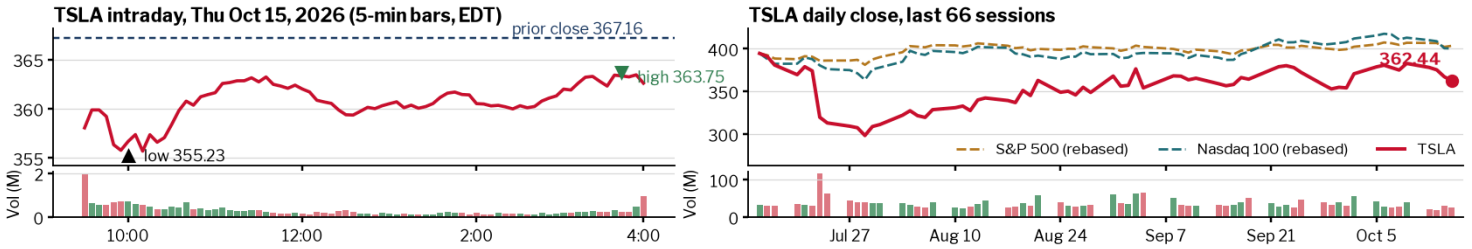
A 1% slip before the reveal

TSLA hit its low in the first half hour and closed down 1.29% as the S&P 500 rose 0.33%. The stock was up 5% in premarket trading Friday after the Roadster show, Reuters reported.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$362.44	−$4.72	$360.57	$363.75	$355.23
Thu Oct 15, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*−1.29% vs $367.16*	*regular session*	*3:40 p.m. EDT bar*	*10:00 a.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**52-WEEK RANGE**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**YEAR TO DATE**
26.61M	$297–$499	$1.43T	−3.35% / +1.22%	−19.41%
−26.9% vs 30-session avg 36.42M	*$297.38 (Jul 29, 2026) to $498.83 (Dec 22, 2025)*	*3.95B shares (10-Q cover, Jul 16) × close*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs Dec 31, 2025 close*

52-WEEK RANGE, OCT 15





As of close Oct 15, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 15 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	YTD
TSLA	**−1.29%**	**−3.35%**	**+1.22%**	**−19.41%**
S&P 500	+0.33%	−0.27%	+2.55%	+13.13%
Nasdaq 100	−0.05%	−2.57%	+3.42%	+18.56%
RIVN	+0.54%	−9.14%	−14.51%	−33.94%
GM	+0.73%	+1.71%	−0.75%	+2.88%
F	+2.16%	+0.49%	−7.79%	−6.17%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, RETRIEVED FRI OCT 16, 8:13 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 19	73,322	35,791	0.49	42.6%	$450 / $250
Oct 23	98,229	67,398	0.69	62.9%	$400 / $220
Oct 30	65,218	52,336	0.80	52.7%	$400 / $380
All expiries	**3,290,438**	**2,530,109**	**0.77**		**30-day IV index 45.2**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 16

Strong buy	4
Buy	15
Hold	21
Sell	2
Strong sell	2
Mean rating (1 = strong buy)	2.36
Mean target (38 analysts)	$397.83 (+9.8%)
Median target	$412.50
High / low target	$600.00 / $128.11

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	70.93M
Change vs. mid-September	−4.4%
Short % of float	2.01%
Days to cover	1.79
Held by insiders	17.82%
Held by institutions	43.71%
BlackRock, Jun 30	5.42%
Vanguard, Jun 30	4.66%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 15 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS $1.08)	335.6
Forward P/E (EPS est. $2.18)	167.1
Price/sales (rev. $103.6B)	13.8
Beta (5-year monthly)	1.92
50-day average	$358.76 (+1.0%)
200-day average	$388.49 (−6.7%)
Q3 EPS est. (24 analysts)	$0.45
Q3 revenue est. (28)	$28.11B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 15	GLJ Research	Sell	$24.86
Oct 12	Jefferies	Hold	$350 to $400
Oct 8	Tigress Financial	Buy	$550
Oct 7	Yorkville Ives	Outperform (initiated)	$500
Oct 7	UBS	Neutral*	$385 to $391
Sep 28	JPMorgan	Neutral	$445 to $415
Sep 25	StoneX	Buy	$475

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Through Oct 18	Paris Motor Show, public days
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry
Wed Oct 21	**Q3 results after close; webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT**
Fri Oct 30	Cybercab answers due to NHTSA

*Largest single option positions: Jan 15, 2027 $960 calls (112,189 OI) and $940 calls (93,666). Prices, volume, returns and moving averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 15). Consensus, targets, rating actions, short interest (as of Sep 30), ownership (holders as of Jun 30) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Fri Oct 16, 8:13 a.m. EDT; P/E (price to earnings per share, EPS) and price/sales recomputed at the Oct 15 close. *UBS: Yahoo Finance lists Neutral; TheFly listed Buy. Tigress: TheFly. Yorkville Ives: EV. Shares: Tesla 10-Q cover page, Jul 16, 2026. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) is contracts outstanding after Thursday's close, P/C is the put/call ratio by OI, ATM IV is implied volatility at the $362.50 strike. Earnings date: Tesla 8-K, Oct 2. NHTSA deadline: EVwire.*